



MICROSOFT

OUTPERFORM

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10 questions ahead of New York NDR, and SpaceX read across

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Stefan SlowinskiBNP Paribas London Branch
(+44) 203 430 8549
stefan.slowinski@uk.bnpparibas.com**Daniel Wang**BNP Paribas Securities Corp¹
+1 646 785 3326
daniel.wang@us.bnpparibas.com**Keeler Patton**BNP Paribas Securities Corp¹
(+1) 646 342 6138
keeler.patton@us.bnpparibas.com

We are hosting Microsoft for investor meetings on June 10 in NYC. Ahead of this event, we outline 10 questions that we think encapsulate the current investor debate. We also provide our thoughts on recent SpaceX disclosures and look at key announcements following last week's Build conference.

10 key questions for Microsoft that tackle the core investor debate

In our view, the key debates currently span Copilot adoption and monetization, demand for GPU compute, and the economics of agentic workloads (particularly at the application layer). Moreover, we also expect greater scrutiny around Microsoft's AI infrastructure buildout as the hyperscalers' AI ambitions appear to now be outpacing their operating cash flow generation, bringing into focus how future capacity additions may ultimately be funded beyond cash flow (and even corporate debt). Additionally, recent datapoints including SpaceX's AI cloud disclosures (Alphabet and Anthropic) as well as Alphabet's equity financing may suggest that the revenue opportunity associated with AI infrastructure is larger than investors previously appreciated (but so too may be the capex required to pursue that opportunity). Pricing power may help drive Azure growth higher into the 40s%, but capex could see another meaningful step up in CY'26.

Build 2026 feedback: encouraging progress, but unlikely to shift the narrative

In our view, Microsoft's Build conference was broadly a step in the right direction and reinforced management's ambition to participate in every layer of the AI stack (infrastructure, models, and agents / applications). While the introduction of the MAI model family demonstrates tangible progress in Microsoft's proprietary model capabilities, our sense is that investors would like to see a more competitive frontier model offering (with sufficient benchmark validation) before underwriting confidence in Microsoft's ability to effectively compete with OpenAI / Anthropic in model development. That said, we were more encouraged by the announcement of Scout and broader Copilot Autopilot capabilities, which have the potential to introduce additional consumption-based monetization vectors (in part to offset the compute intensity of these offerings).

Microsoft (+)	MSFT US				Performance ⁽¹⁾	1w	1m	3m	12m
*Closing Price (8 June 2026)	USD411.7				Absolute(%)	(7)	1	2	(10)
Volume (USDm / EURm)	13,768.1 / 11,911.2				Rel. Software(%)	(1)	(3)	(3)	0
Market cap (USDbn / EURbn)	3,053.8 / 2,642.0				Rel. MSCI USA(%)	NC	NC	NC	NC
Free float (USDbn / EURbn)	3,051.4 / 2,639.8								
EV (USDbn / EURbn)	2,979.8 / 2,577.9								
Country / Sub Sector	USA / Software								
Financials	06/26e	06/27e	06/28e	06/29e	Valuation metrics	06/26e	06/27e	06/28e	06/29e
EPS, Adjusted (USD)	17.2	20.0	23.9	28.9	P/E (x)	23.9	20.6	17.2	14.2
EPS, Company (USD)	17.43	19.74	23.70	28.78	Net yield (%)	0.9	1.0	1.1	1.3
EPS - Bloomberg (USD)	17.1	19.5	22.8	27.3	FCF yield (%)	2.1	0.7	2.1	3.3
Net dividend (USD)	3.7	4.1	4.7	5.3	EV/Sales (x)	9.0	7.6	6.3	5.1
Sales (USDm)	330,172	389,034	467,305	559,874	EV/EBITDA (x)	15.6	12.5	9.7	7.7
EBITA, Adj. (USDm)	157,969	183,092	217,828	260,766	EV/EBITA (x)	18.9	16.2	13.5	11.0
Net profit, Adj.(USDm)	128,336	148,118	175,889	211,562	EV/CE (x)	6.7	5.3	4.3	3.5
ROCE (%)	28.5	26.2	25.9	25.9					
Net Debt/EBITDA, Adj. (x)	-	-	-	-					

All valuation metrics based on adjusted figures

Source: BNP Paribas Equity Research (estimates), Bloomberg (consensus) (1) In listing currency, with dividend reinvested

See page 8 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures, Non-US Research Analyst disclosures and BNP Paribas Group Corporate Social Responsibility ("CSR") policies. BNP Paribas has adopted strict CSR policies that govern financing and investment in certain sectors. For time of dissemination, please refer to the Cube. *Closing Price (8 June 2026). (1) FINRA member firm and broker-dealer registered with the U.S. Securities Exchange Commission

Revisiting our SpaceX revenue / GW calculations

We revisit our analysis of SpaceX's recently disclosed AI infrastructure agreements, where updated disclosures continue to suggest that revenue per GW may be materially higher than we previously assumed (see note: [SpaceX S-1 Highlights GPU Tightness and AI Infra Monetization Trends](#)). Recent disclosures indicating SpaceX's Anthropic deal is for 325K NVIDIA GPUs could imply the agreement is for ~500 MW of compute (230K chips in Colossus 1 and 95K chips in Colossus 2). With Anthropic paying \$15bn annually, this would suggest the Anthropic deal implies over \$30bn revenue / GW, well ahead of our previous estimate of \$15bn – \$24bn.

Separately, SpaceX also disclosed Alphabet has agreed to pay \$920m per month (or ~\$11bn annually) for access to 110K GPUs. Assuming this is for spare capacity in Colossus 2, 110K GPUs would equate to ~200 MW of GB200 / GB300s, implying the Alphabet deal could be approaching \$50bn revenue / GW. While we acknowledge these are intended to be short duration agreements executed in an exceptionally supply constrained environment, it nonetheless provides further evidence that demand for AI infrastructure remains robust, for now.

We believe this may provide upside potential to Azure estimates if pricing can strengthen when contracts are renewed, driving growth higher into the mid 40s%.

Figure 1: We now estimate Anthropic's SpaceX deal implies ~\$30bn / GW

Anthropic deal	MW	# of Chips
Colossus I	300 MW	230,000
Colossus II	181 MW	95,000
Total chips leased	481 MW	325,000
Revenue from Anthropic (annual)	\$15bn	
Capacity leased	481 MW	
Implied Revenue / GW	\$31bn	

Source: SpaceX S-1, BNP Paribas Equity Research estimates

Ten Questions for Microsoft

Copilot

During Microsoft's FQ3'26 earnings call, the company indicated Copilot seats were on track to exceed 25m by the end of June. Where are we on that milestone? And more broadly, how has the early momentum / initial customer reception been to the introduction of E7?

We are seeing signs of improving feedback from Copilot users, especially those with Frontier access. But oftentimes, these newer capabilities are not immediately available to the broader installed base and enterprise deployment cycles can be slow. How is Microsoft thinking about shortening the time between a new feature reaching preview and becoming broadly deployable across enterprise customers?

Agentic workflows are likely to make Copilot a more compute-intensive product over time. How is Microsoft thinking about balancing user engagement and monetization against the incremental compute costs of serving these workloads? And as Microsoft deploys more first-party services on MAIA, what inference efficiency gains are you seeing relative to NVIDIA-based infrastructure?

GitHub Copilot recently moved from a pure seat-based model toward a seat plus consumption model. What have been the initial learnings from that transition in terms of customer adoption / usage patterns and monetization? And how are those learnings influencing Microsoft's broader thinking around AI pricing?

Azure

Can you elaborate on what the key efficiency gains Microsoft is able to extract from its fungible Azure fleet that is enabling the Azure outperformance in recent quarters? And how sustainable are these optimization benefits of improving the utilization / efficiency of the underlying infrastructure?

Given ongoing tightness in AI compute, how is Microsoft thinking about pricing as Azure AI contracts come up for renewal? And with the inflation we are seeing in many of the AI datacenter components, are there any contractual hedging mechanisms in the OpenAI commitment that would help Microsoft preserve its unit economics?

As agentic AI workloads scale, **what incremental demand are agents creating for 'core' Azure services.** Are you seeing Azure consumption broaden beyond just GPUs?

How do you view MAIA's role within Microsoft's AI stack? Today, it seems MAIA is being used to reduce inference costs and improve economics for first-party AI products such as Copilot. And presumably, MAIA access can also be a commercial offering sold to external customers. So when should we see MAIA become a more meaningful part of the Azure monetization story?

Capex and margins

Microsoft has historically funded its datacenter capacity expansion through operating cash flow. But the industry appears to be entering a new phase where the capital intensity of AI infrastructure could outstrip operating cash flow generation. **As Microsoft's AI ambitions continue to scale, how should we think about the company's funding mix for AI infrastructure?** And would you consider alternative financing structures beyond traditional corporate debt to fund this AI capacity?

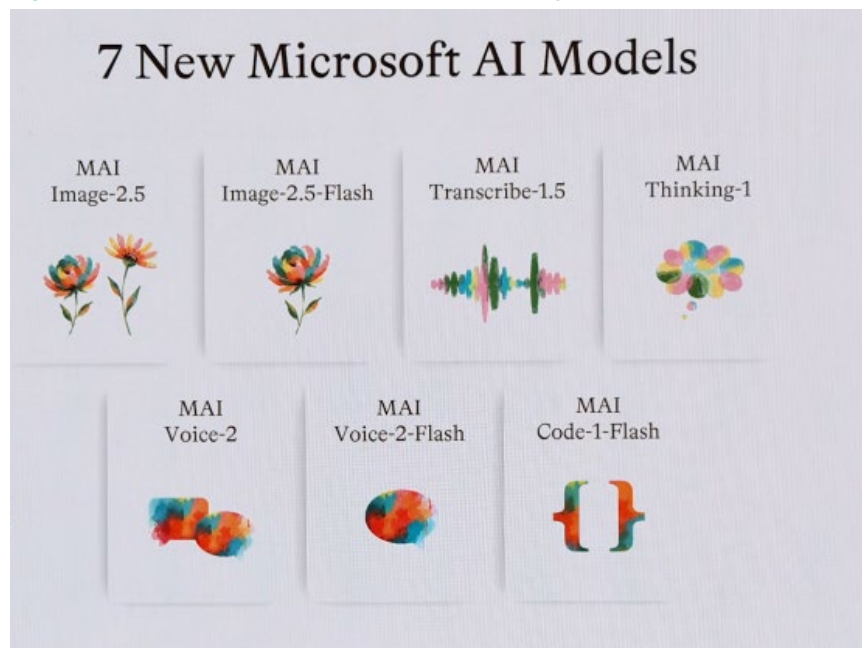
For FY27, Microsoft outlined double digit revenue growth, double digit operating income growth, and operating expense growth in the mid to high single digits. **As we think about FY27 margins, how should we weigh the various moving pieces**, especially with ramping AI revenues and tougher compares in some of Microsoft's higher-margin businesses?

Feedback from Microsoft Build

Microsoft's Build conference (hosted last week) largely reinforced the company's strategy of participating across every layer of the AI stack, with announcements spanning infrastructure, proprietary models, and agentic AI capabilities (amongst several other announcements). Most notably, Microsoft introduced a family of seven internally developed MAI models, including its first reasoning model, alongside new coding, image, voice, and transcription models.

That said, we believe investor enthusiasm around the new MAI models has been muted. While the new family of MAI models serves as an encouraging first step in Microsoft's proprietary model capabilities, they do not appear competitive with the leading frontier models from OpenAI / Anthropic and currently lack both the breadth of capabilities and benchmark validation that investors would likely require to gain confidence in Microsoft's ability to emerge as a leading frontier model developer. And even if Microsoft's near-term objective is not necessarily to compete directly at the frontier, we believe the absence of a clearly competitive frontier offering has hurt the perception around Microsoft's ability to keep pace should model leadership become increasingly important over time.

Figure 2: Microsoft unveiled seven new internally developed AI models at Build



Source: Microsoft Build Presentation

As for Microsoft's agent-related announcements, we view the Scout and broader Copilot Autopilot capabilities more favorably. Specifically, we believe the evolution toward increasingly autonomous workflows enables Microsoft to potentially introduce additional consumption-based monetization vectors that could help offset the higher compute intensity associated with these agentic workloads. However, product innovation represents only one aspect of the investor debate, as we believe the greater unlock lies in accelerating the pace in which new capabilities move from announcement to broad customer availability. While our sense is that Copilot feedback from Frontier users (with access to newer functionalities) is trending positively, we believe the market is increasingly looking for evidence that Microsoft can shorten the lag between unveiling new Copilot functionality and deploying it at scale across its large installed base.

Figure 3: Microsoft Scout overview for Frontier preview program users

What can Microsoft Scout do?

Microsoft Scout combines local and cloud capabilities in a single desktop application:

- **Acts on your files:** Creates, edits, and searches documents in your workspace. Works with Word, Excel, PowerPoint, code files, and more.
- **Runs commands:** Executes shell commands, builds, tests, and scripts with a tiered permission system.
- **Automates browsers:** Navigates web pages, fills forms, and interacts with web applications by using Playwright.
- **Connects to Microsoft 365:** Manages your email, calendar, Teams messages, OneDrive files, and meetings.
- **Works autonomously:** Runs in the background on schedules or triggers you define.
- **Delegates work:** Launches specialized sub-agents for parallel research, code review, and complex tasks.

How it works

1. **You describe your task** in natural language in the chat interface.
2. **Microsoft Scout selects tools** and works through the steps, showing progress in real time.
3. **You approve sensitive actions** before they execute (sending email, running commands, writing files).
4. **Microsoft Scout delivers results** directly in the conversation or saves files to your workspace.

Source: Microsoft

Investment case, valuation and risks

Microsoft (Outperform, Target Price USD555)

Investment case

We see Microsoft as positioned to benefit from a leadership position in technologies with strong secular growth tailwinds, including Cloud Computing and Data Analytics (Azure, Synapse, Fabric), Software Development (GitHub, Visual Studio and the Windows Platform), Productivity (Office), Collaboration (Teams), Enterprise automation (Dynamics and Power Platform), Cyber Security, Advertising (Netflix and OpenAI partnerships, and own services like LinkedIn and Bing), and Gaming (Xbox and Activision). Microsoft is also now leveraging Generative AI across its products, which we believe will drive increased usage and ARPU increases. The company's OpenAI partnership will also likely help drive revenue growth acceleration. We also see Microsoft proactively managing its cost structure, despite accelerating depreciation costs, helping maintain margins at a high level. In addition, the company's communication is amongst the best in Big Tech, providing investors with a clearer understanding of investment priorities and shareholder return visibility.

Valuation methodology

We use a 25x NTM P/E multiple (using ex OpenAI gains and losses earnings) to value Microsoft, based on our FY28 EPS estimates, discounted back, and we also add value for Microsoft's stake in OpenAI.

Risks

To the upside:

Faster than expected uptake for Microsoft's Co-pilot would be a positive catalyst for the stock. Microsoft Azure's growth and market share gain could exceed our expectations, driving higher than expected revenue growth. Similarly, any of Dynamics, Office 365, Gaming, Devices, LinkedIn or Search Advertising could exceed our expectations in a given year or over a multi-year period. Greater market confidence around OpenAI, and OpenAI's ability to raise capital and achieve FCF break-even, would also help confidence.

To the downside:

The inability to meet demand, including difficulty accessing GPUs, may negatively impact Azure growth. The dependency on OpenAI for its GPT model also creates a strategic risk, while the increased dependence on Generative AI for growth also creates risk as it is still an unproven technology in the enterprise. Cyclical weakness in core businesses, such as Windows, could last longer than expected, weighing on growth and driving valuation pressure. Increasing investor concern around SaaS business models and headcount growth dependence is also a risk. Regulatory risk from competition concerns over hyperscalers' dominance of cloud workloads could also factor. Lastly the need to continuously innovate in a highly competitive market could weigh on long term profitability.

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Stefan Slowinski BNP Paribas London
Branch

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Atlassian	TEAM US	/
Cadence Design Systems	CDNS US	3; 4; 8
Cloudflare Inc	NET US	/
CoreWeave	CRWV US	/
CrowdStrike Holdings Inc	CRWD US	/
Datadog Inc	DDOG US	/
Dynatrace Inc	DT US	/
HubSpot	HUBS US	/
IBM	IBM US	2; 3; 4; 7; 8; 9; 10
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Nebius Group	NBIS US	11- Net short position
Nvidia	NVDA US	6
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Palo Alto Networks	PANW US	2; 3; 4; 7; 8; 9
Salesforce	CRM US	2; 3; 4; 7; 8; 9; 10
Samsara Inc	IOT US	/
ServiceNow Inc	NOW US	2; 3; 4; 8
Snowflake	SNOW US	7; 9; 10
Synopsys, Inc.	SNPS US	/
Veeva Systems	VEEV US	/
Vertex Inc	VERX US	/
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Workiva	WK US	/
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Outperform (O/P): The stock is expected to outperform the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst’s team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

Neutral: The stock is expected to perform in line with the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst’s team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

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ESG integration methodology: The BNP Paribas approach offers an alternative to mechanistic ESG scores and leverages the in-depth knowledge of our industry equity research teams by combining quantitative and qualitative factors. There are three steps to our framework; firstly, our teams build a materiality map to assess which ESG topics are most relevant to their respective industries. Secondly, for the chosen topics, companies are assessed relative to sector peers. The assessment can be based on metrics and qualitative judgements. Each company is given a one to five score per topic, with five being the best. Thirdly, based on the topic scores, and any other significant ESG factors, we identify companies in the sector as ESG Leaders, ESG Laggards or ESG Average. The definition of the ratings is shown below; they are not based on the average topic score as some topic scores can be more material than others.

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Ratings	Stocks coverage		Investment Banking Services Within the previous 12 months	
	Counts	%*	Counts	%
Outperform (Buy)	698	51	168	24
Neutral (Hold)	485	35	107	22
Underperform (Sell)	194	14	39	20

* Please note that the percentages might not add up to 100% because of rounding.

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Price and Ratings Chart

Microsoft

Historical Closing Price & Target Price (closing price as of 08/06/2026)



Source: BNP Paribas

Historical rating & target price changes

Date & Time of Dissemination (London time)	Rating (1)	Target Price	Closing Price	Key Changes	Person(s) Involved
30 Apr. 2026 22:42	+	USD555.00	USD407.78	TP down	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
10 Apr. 2026 14:14	+	USD556.00	USD370.87	TP down	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
26 Jan. 2026 21:43	+	USD659.00	USD470.28	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
3 Nov. 2025 05:56	+	USD632.00	USD517.03	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
1 Aug. 2025 11:51	+	USD630.00	USD524.11	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
28 Jul. 2025 05:41	+	USD625.00	USD512.50	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
26 Jun. 2025 21:19	+	USD606.00	USD497.45	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
2 May 2025 06:12	+	USD500.00	USD435.28	TP up	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
17 Apr. 2025 05:55	+	USD483.00	USD367.78	TP down	S. Slowinski, D. Wang, K. Patton
31 Jul. 2024 11:50	+	USD500.00	USD418.35	TP down	S. Slowinski, K. Patton
22 Jul. 2024 06:23	+	USD525.00	USD442.94	TP up	S. Slowinski, K. Patton
2 May 2024 05:59	+	USD495.00	USD397.84	TP up	S. Slowinski, K. Patton, B. Castillo-Bernaus
31 Jan. 2024 14:22	+	USD485.00	USD397.58	TP up	S. Slowinski, L. Lu, K. Patton
18 Jan. 2024 05:11	+	USD471.00	USD389.47	Rating up, TP up	S. Slowinski, B. Castillo-Bernaus, L. Lu, K. Patton
27 Oct. 2023 17:21	=	USD350.00	USD329.81	TP up	S. Slowinski, L. Lu, K. Patton
14 Aug. 2023 06:04	=	USD325.00	USD324.04	TP down	S. Slowinski, L. Lu, K. Patton
26 Jul. 2023 08:06	=	USD361.00	USD337.77	TP down	S. Slowinski, L. Lu, K. Patton
19 Jul. 2023 06:04	=	USD365.00	USD355.08	TP up	S. Slowinski, L. Lu, K. Patton

(1) With effect from 23 September 2024, BNP Paribas changed its research rating system - please refer to the 'Explanation of Research Ratings'.

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MICROSOFT (Outperform)

Price at 8 Jun. 26 / Target Price

Software - USA

USD411.7 / USD555 +35%

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Management

Satya Nadella, CEO
Amy Hood, CFO
Scott Guthrie, Executive Vice President

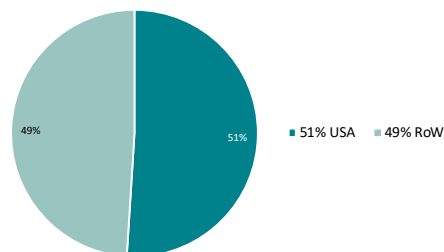
Ownership structure

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BlackRock	4.5%
Capital Group	4.0%
State Street Global Advisors	4.0%
Fidelity Management & Research	2.9%
T.Row e Price	2.4%
Geode Capital Management	1.6%
Norges Bank IM	1.0%
Other Shareholders	71.5%

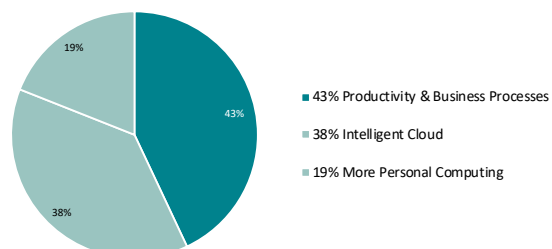
Peer group YTD performance

Stock	Price		YTD performance in EUR (%)	
	(08 Jun. 26)		Abs.	Rel. Sector
Nebius Group (=)	USD	218.0	176.5	209
Datadog (+)	USD	231.7	74.9	95
Palo Alto (+)	USD	266.3	50.1	68
CrowdStrike (=)	USD	658.8	45.4	62
CoreWeave (+)	USD	102.4	42.4	59
Cloudflare (-)	USD	247.8	28.9	44
Navan (+)	USD	21.4	26.1	41
Cadence Design (+)	USD	394.2	22.3	37
Zoom (-)	USD	101.2	19.7	34
Oracle (+)	USD	211.8	11.9	25
Snowflake (+)	USD	240.5	10.4	23
Synopsys, Inc. (-)	USD	473.5	0.6	12
Samsara (+)	USD	34.1	(0.3)	11
Dynatrace (=)	USD	41.9	(1.1)	10
IBM (-)	USD	280.8	(1.4)	10
Microsoft (+)	USD	411.7	(12.2)	(2)
Veeva Systems (+)	USD	167.2	(21.4)	(12)
ServiceNow (+)	USD	114.2	(25.4)	(17)
Adobe (=)	USD	245.0	(27.0)	(18)
Salesforce (+)	USD	182.6	(28.7)	(20)
Workday (+)	USD	143.8	(31.7)	(24)
Vertex (+)	USD	12.9	(33.0)	(25)
Atlassian (+)	USD	97.9	(37.7)	(30)
Zscaler (+)	USD	129.3	(40.9)	(34)
Workiva (+)	USD	48.3	(42.1)	(35)
HubSpot (=)	USD	208.1	(46.2)	(40)
Intuit (=)	USD	305.5	(54.3)	(49)

Revenue by geography - FY24/25



Revenue by reported segment - FY24/25



Analyst

Stefan Slowinski (+44) 203 430 8549
stefan.slowinski@uk.bnpparibas.com

Sector calendar

11 Jun. 26 **Zoom**: AGM (19:00 CET)
Adobe: Q2 Earnings 2026 (22:00 CET)
12 Jun. 26 **Fortinet Inc**: AGM (19:00 CET)
15 Jun. 26 **Datadog**: AGM (20:30 CET)
16 Jun. 26 **Workday**: AGM (18:00 CET)
18 Jun. 26 **Autodesk**: AGM

